MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SATCHEL, PHYSICIAN'S, BOSTON STYLE, THREE COMPARTMENT

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a physician's leather satchel, suitable for retaining and transporting emergency treatment medicines, supplies, and surgical and diagnostic instruments.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or requests for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

V-T-291	Thread, Linen.
V-T-295	Thread, Nylon
KK-L-154	Leather, Cattlehide, Bag and Case.
NN-P-530	Plywood, Flat Panel.
QQ-A-200/9	Aluminum Alloy Bar, Rod, Shapes, Tube and Wire, Extended, 6063
QQ-B-626	Brass, Leaded and Non-Leaded, Rods, Shapes, Forgings, and Flat Products with Finished Edges, Bars, Flat Wire and Strips.
PPP-B-585	Box, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	Box, Wood, Cleated Plywood.
PPP-B-621	Box, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Military

MIL-L-10547	Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

STANDARDS

Federal

FED-STD-151	Metals; Test Methods.
FED-STD-191	Textile Test Methods.
FED-STD-751	Stitches, Seams and Stitchings.

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards requested by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Except as specified herein, materials shall conform to the applicable portions of the referenced specifications and standards. When materials are not specifically designated, those used shall be of the highest quality used in commercial practice.

3.1.1 Covering. The covering shall be genuine top-grain cattlehide leather not less than 3/64 inch thick, shark grain finish, conforming to type I, class 2 of KK-L-154.

3.1.2 Lining. The interior lining of the satchel shall be vinyl-coated cloth, weighing not less than 7 ounces per square yard. The color of the lining shall be tan.

3.1.2.1 Backing of top and gussets. The backing of the top and gussets shall be a rubber compound impregnated paper, having a minimum thickness of 0.060 inch.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-21T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.1.3 Frame. The frame shall be fabricated of aluminum alloy, 6063-T5, in accordance with QQ-A-200/9.

3.1.4 Carrying handles. The handles shall be fabricated of leather conforming to 3.1.1, except the fillers shall conform to type I, class 1 of KK-L-154. Splitting shall be permitted.

3.1.5 Lock, hasps, dee-rings, clips, rivets and feet. Lock, hasps, dee-rings, rivets and feet shall be fabricated from steel, nickel plated, except that the hand piece or operator for the lock shall be die cast zinc. As an alternate, nickel plated half-hard brass, composition 360 of QQ-B-626 shall be used for the hasps, rivets and feet. The lock bolt housing shall be carbon steel nickel plated or black oxidized.

3.1.6 Backing for bottom, sides and compartment lids. The backing for the bottom of the satchel shall be first quality chipboard, having a minimum thickness of 0.090 inch. The backing for the lower sides and the stiffener for the compartment lid shall be first quality chipboard or cardboard, having a minimum thickness of 0.080 inch.

3.1.7 Cloth reinforcement. The cloth reinforcement strips shall be cotton percale, commercial grade, having a minimum 80 square or 160 yarns to the inch.

3.1.8 Compartments. Compartments shall be fabricated of cold rolled steel sheeting, 24 gauge (0.023 inch thick). Finish shall be tan baked enamel. Compartment lids shall be covered with tan vinyl coated knit cloth, having a minimum weight of 7 ounces per square yard. As an alternate, the compartments shall be fabricated of acrylonitrile butadiene styrene plastic.

3.1.8.1 Compartment padding. Pads for the fragile items shall be tan or charcoal gray colored polyurethane, soft foam commercial grade. Thickness shall be 1/4 inch.

3.1.8.2 Compartment elastic tape. The elastic tape for the padded compartment shall be tan or light brown, 1/4 inch wide, high quality commercial grade. Elastic strands shall be completely covered and the tape shall be tightly woven. Slackness or lack of tension shall not be evident after moderate stretch of the tape by hand.

3.1.8.3 Straps for compartment fasteners. The straps for the snap fasteners shall be clear vinyl plastic, 3-1/2 by 3/4 inches and 1/16 inch thick.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.1.9 Bottle loop strap and strap holder. The bottle loop strap and strap holder shall be clear, vinyl plastic strips, of a commercial grade polyvinyl chloride or polyvinyl chloride-acetate copolymer. There shall be no plasticizer migration, "bleed out" or deleterious properties.

3.1.10 Plywood. The plywood for the divider shall conform to NN-P-530 and shall be group B, Douglas fir, exterior type, grade A-B, 3 ply, bonded, water resistant.

3.1.11 Thread. The thread used shall be bonded monocord nylon in accordance with V-T-295, Type III. The thread used for outside stitching shall be size 6. The needle thread for the lining shall be size FF and the bobbin thread shall be size F. As an alternate, the thread shall be linen, 5 ply, type B, lock-stitch twist, class 1 or 2, in accordance with V-T-291.

3.1.12 End reinforcements. End reinforcements shall be 0.015 inch fiberboard, commercial grade.

3.1.13 Miscellaneous hardware. Snap fasteners shall be Rau Fastener Co. series 6020, 6021, 6032 and 6042 for cap, socket, eyelet and stud respectively, or equal. The finish shall be bronze, Rau F-4 or equal. Three-eighth inch long staples or 3/4 inch long wire nails shall be used for holding plywood in place.

3.1.14 Cements and adhesives. Adhesives and cements for the leather, wood, vinyl and paperboard materials shall be commercial grade especially intended for the specific application.

3.1.15 Color. The satchel shall be black, including covering, handles, straps and thread.

3.2 Design and Construction. The general design of the satchel shall be as shown in figure 1. The bottom compartment shall open to full length and full width for easy access to the interior. The divided top shall have three compartments. On one side of the divided top there shall be a full length compartment of sufficient size to accommodate a blood pressure apparatus. The other side of the divided top shall be partitioned at the center forming two compartments. One of these two compartments shall be equipped with straps or loops for securing all sizes of ampules and vials. The compartments shall be equipped with covers secured with snap fasteners. The bottom compartment shall have adjustable bottle strap loops, on one side, sewn to the lining. The construction

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

of the satchel shall consist of a leather covered, sewn-in metal frame, with double drop handles, top turn lock and metal feet. The outside of the body shall be constructed of three pieces of leather as specified in 3.1.1; one piece forming the bottom and one piece forming each side joined at the center of the end panels. The lower edges of the side pieces shall overlap one inch onto the bottom and be attached to the bottom by a continuous line of stitches. The bottom of the satchel shall be reinforced with chipboard as specified in 3.1.6. The four lower corners shall be reinforced on the outside with leather as specified in 3.1.1. The interior of the satchel and the compartments shall be lined with washable plastic. The compartments intended for storage of ampules and vials shall be padded with polyurethane foam as specified in 3.1.8.1

3.2.1 Dimensions. The outside dimensions shall be 17 inches long, 8 inches wide and 12 inches high, with a tolerance of ± 1/8 inch in each dimension.

3.2.2 Carrying handles. The satchel shall be provided with two carrying handles, each 5-1/2 ± 1/4 inch long. Each handle shall be fabricated of leather as specified in 3.1.4 and shall be shaped to fit the hand comfortably when the two handles are together as shown in figure 1. The handle shall be secured to the satchel by means of dee-rings around which end leather pieces of the handle are looped. The dees shall be securely attached to clips which are riveted to the frame.

3.2.3 Lock. The lock (see 3.1.5) shall be secured to the frame at the top center of the satchel with the housing for the bolt concealed on the inside and the operator or bolt actuating mechanism on the exterior, with the leather covering between. The members shall be securely attached by riveting. The concealed locking device shall lock the bag at both ends. The top turn mechanism of the lock shall be capable of instantly releasing the lock, and at the same time set it for the closing operation. The keys shall be included.

3.2.4 Feet. Nine metal feet shall be attached to the bottom of the satchel; one foot at each corner, one at the midpoint of each side and one in the center of the satchel bottom.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2.5 Stitching. Stitch type shall be 101 or 301 conforming to FED-STD-751 with a minimum of 4 stitches per inch. Stitch type 301 shall be used in all cases where stitching is accomplished before assembly. Stitch type 101 shall be used for assembly. End seams shall be double-row stitched. At the end of each row of stitches, there shall be at least three backstitches. In lieu of backstitching for the type 101 stitch, the thread at the end of each row shall be pulled tight and excess removed. The thread shall be waxed or glazed to prevent unraveling.

3.3 Identification marking. A metal plate, permanently etched or die-stamped with the manufacturer's name or registered trademark and the contract number shall be secured to the outside surface of the bottom of the satchel. As an alternate, the required marking shall be applied directly to the surface of the satchel by hot stamping. A foil or leaf contrasting in color to that of the satchel shall be used, such as imitation gold or silver. Numerals shall be arabic and all letters, numerals and other characters shall be of such size as to be clearly legible at normal distance from the satchel.

3.4 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Satchels shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the component or material, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the item identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the test method, and individual test results.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Components. Sampling of components shall be in accordance with the applicable subsidiary specifications referenced herein.

4.2.2 For chemical analysis of metals. Four ounces of each lot of each metal used in the construction of the item shall be selected for chemical analysis as specified in 4.4.1.

4.2.3 End item sampling.

4.2.3.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with inspection Level II of MIL-STD-105. The unit for examination shall be the unit of issue.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Satchel. The satchels shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements of this specification. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with 4.3.2. The acceptable quality levels shall be as specified below:

Major - 2.5 defects per 100 units.
Total (major and minor combined) - 6.5 defects per 100 units.

4.3.2 Classification of defects. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with, but not restricted to, the following classification of defects. Additional defects shall be classified in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Table I. Classification of defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Color and finish	Color not as specified	X	
Leather components	Color not uniform		X
	Finish of leather not as specified	X	
Thread	Color not as specified		X
Metal components	Not specified finish		X
Design	Any characteristic not in accordance with the specified requirements	X	
Material			
General	Any component or assembly not fabricated of the specified material	X	
Quality of leather	Not full or correct grain	X	
	Any hole, cut, or rupture	X	
	Any of the following imperfections present to a degree where the condition will have a serious affect on serviceability or appearance: open grub or tick marks, open or badly healed scratches, brands, boney, loose or pipey leather, or otherwise defective, e.g., open scratch on exterior surface of satchel	X	
	Any of the following imperfections present to a degree where the condition will affect serviceability or appearance, but not seriously: Grub or tick marks, healed scratches, brands, boney, loose or pipey leather, or otherwise defective		X
	Flaky, spongy, or stretchy leather		X
	Fat wrinkles		X
Interior	Lining wrinkled or not adhered properly		X
	Compartment not padded		X
	Snap fasteners missing		X
Metal components			
General	Finish not even or otherwise imperfect		X
	Dented, damaged, or malformed		X

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Table I. Classification of defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Metal Components General (cont'd)	Any hole where hole is not required		X
	Any hole missing where required		X
	Component loose or insecurely fastened	X	
	Any rough or sharp edge, burr, fin, metal splinter, or sliver that may be injurious to user	X	
Workmanship and attachment of rivets, burrs, and washers	Any rivet not securely set or clinched		X
	Any rivet, burr, or washer not suited for intended purpose		X
	Head of any rivet broken off or bent over	X	
	Peening of any rivet producing a rough surface or unnecessarily high projection on interior of satchel or insert assembly	X	
	Any rivet missing		X
	Any rivet reversed, i.e., head of rivet is not on the side of the component as specified or in keeping with commercial practice		X
Construction and workmanship General (applicable to all component and assemblies unless otherwise indicated herein)	Any component missing	X	
	Any part fractured, ripped, torn, punctured, malformed, or otherwise damaged	X	
	Any operation omitted, improperly performed, or not in accordance with acceptable commercial practice	X	
	Any component misplaced or assembly malformed	X	
	Any functioning part that will not operate as intended or requires abnormal force to operate	X	
Lock	Lock does not function or both keys missing or both keys will not operate lock	X	
Seams and stitching	Not specified stitch type	X	
	Gauge of stitching irregular		X
	Loose stitch tension resulting in a loosely secured seam		X

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Table I. Classification of defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Seams and stitching (cont'd)	More than three continuous stitch locks exposed on surface of leather but seam tight		X
	Tight stitch tension, i.e., stitches rupture leather or may break in use of end item	X	
	Any restitched seam affecting appearance or serviceability		X
	More than two continuous needle holes visible as a result of removal of threads		X
	Any row of stitching omitted	X	
	Four or less stitches per inch	X	
	More than eight stitches per inch damaging leather	X	
	Thread ends not trimmed		X
	Any open seam	X	
	Note: When one or more stitches are broken, or two or more consecutive skipped stitches or runoffs occur on a single stitched seam, or on both rows of stitching on a double-stitched seam, it shall be classified as a major defect. When one or more stitches are broken, or two or more stitches are broken, or two or more consecutive skipped stitches or runoffs occur on only one row of a double stitched seam, it shall be classified as a minor defect.		
	Not backstitched where necessary to secure end of seam or back-stitched with less than three stitches		X
Assembly	Frame warped, bent, or malformed preventing satisfactory closing of satchel	X	
	Carrying handle does not fit the hand comfortably	X	
	Any defect of design or fabrication which causes difficulty in operation of moving parts	X	
	Undue tension or looseness of latches or lock in closing satchel	X	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Table I. Classification of defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Assembly (cont'd)	Any area of leather covering not securely adhered to undercase		X
	Binding not neatly accomplished		X
Marking	Missing, incomplete, incorrect not legible, not specified size, not in proper location, or not accomplished as specified		X

4.3.3 Preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of Section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in table II. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The Inspection Level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Table II. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examination	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Quantity	Quantity in interior packages and shipping containers not as specified.
Packaging and packing materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, tape improperly applied, or containers distorted.
Markings	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4 Component testing. In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the subsidiary specifications other tests specified herein shall be conducted.

4.4.1 Chemical analysis of the metals. The samples selected in accordance with 4.4 shall be analyzed in conformance with methods 111 or 112 of FED-STD-151. In case of dispute, method 111 shall be used for referee analysis.

4.4.2 Vinyl coated cloth. The weight of the fabric shall be determined in accordance with Method 5040 of FED-STD-191.

4.4.2.1 Water resistance. No leakage shall be observed at a water height of 20 inches after 10 minutes, in accordance with Method 5516 of FED-STD-191.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit package. Each satchel shall be closed and latched, and the keys securely tied to the carrying handle. Each satchel shall be inserted into a polyethylene bag of suitable weight and the closure effected by tying or other suitable means. Each bagged satchel shall be packaged in a close-fitting fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.2 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind cmmonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Four (4) satchels shall be packed in a box designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2 or PPP-B-636, type CF, class weather-resistant. Closure and strapping shall be in accordance with the applicable box specification.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2.1.2 Case liner. Each Level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Fiberboard boxes shall be waterproofed in accordance with PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Four (4) satchels shall be packed in a box designed for a type 2 load, and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 2, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Interior packages. Each unit package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The physician's satchel covered by this specification is intended to be used for retaining and transporting emergency treatment medicines, supplies, surgical and diagnostic instruments.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.3 This specification is intended to cover the following items listed in the Federal Supply Catalog.

NSN	Item Identification
6532-00-245-3401	Satchel, Physician's, Boston Style, with Three Compartments

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6532-1094
cs

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

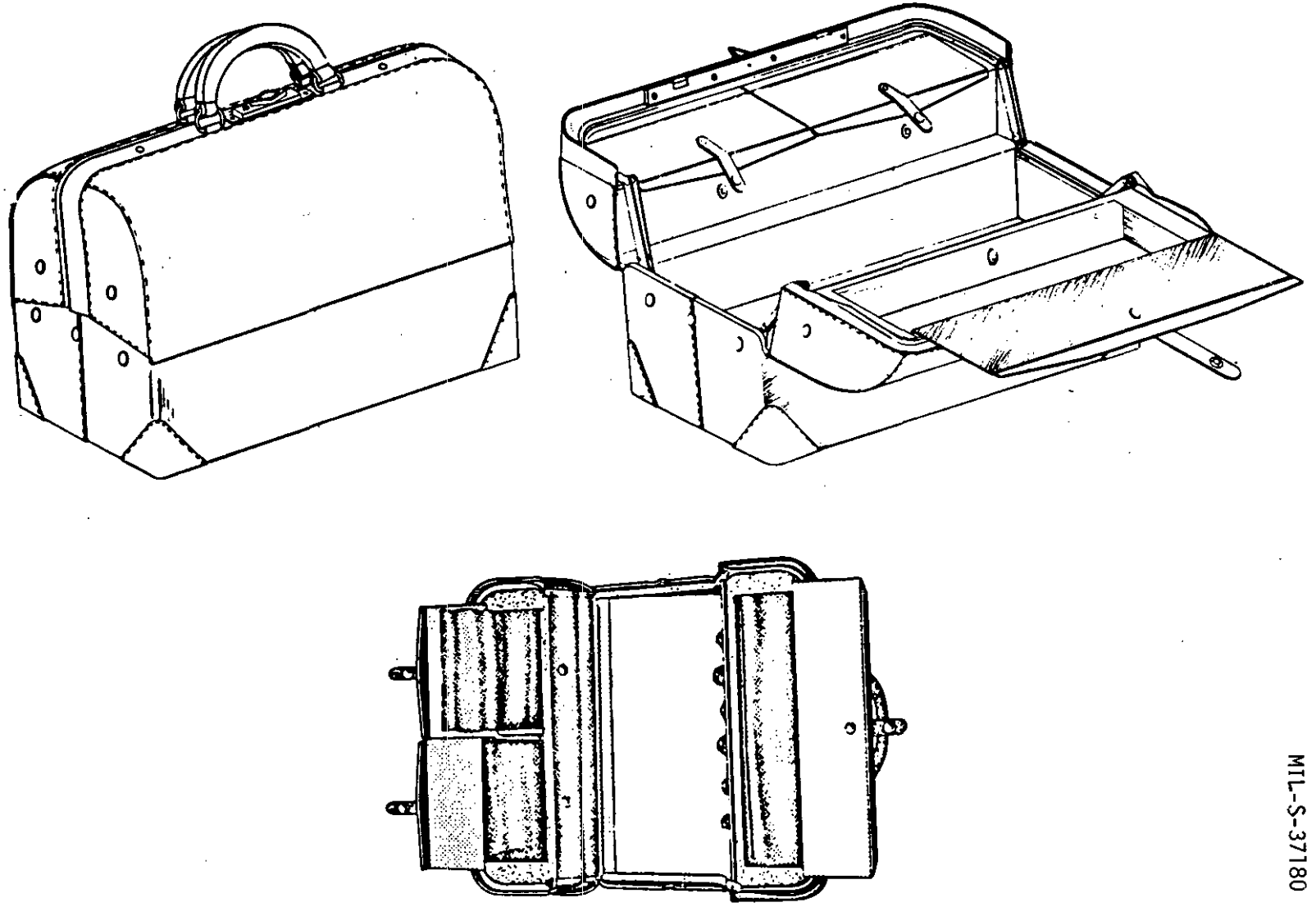


FIGURE 1

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-07
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: The purpose of this form is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers/vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-S-37180

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 72 1426

REPLACES EDITION OF 1 JAN 66 WHICH MAY BE USED

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-21T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.